

of printing higher DPI. If you need to print high-resolution coloured images, go for a printer with 4800 × 1200 DPI or more.

Printer speed. Next comes the number of pages that can be printed in a minute. All printers come with a specific number of good-quality black/colour prints per minute that these can produce. Selection of the model on the basis of prints per minute would also depend on your requirement.

Paper handling. The quantity and types of printing needed at home are the other decisive factors to consider. You must know in advance what kind of stationery you will use for printing. If there will be a lot of printing on cards, envelope or thick paper, you should go for a printer with manual paper feed.

You should also check if automatic duplexing is needed or not. A duplexing feature allows you to print on both sides of the paper. Printers with auto-duplexing tend to cost more. Duplexing can also be done manually if it is not needed very regularly.

Connectivity. When we talk about wireless printers, connectivity is through a wireless Wi-Fi network. Wireless connectivity for a printer should support the latest wireless protocols and should match with your home based network.

You should also check other modes of connectivity. A home based printer should be able to print using a media slot wherein you can connect SD or micro-SD cards. Just having a wireless printer would not suffice, as trends have shown that the number of devices that need to be connected to the home printer has increased in the recent past.

The printer should also support printing from mobile devices and even Cloud.

Inks, cartridges and print heads. A very important aspect of a printer is the ink cartridge it uses. The cost of printer is paid one time, whereas you have a recurring expense on the

ink. So, while choosing a printer, selection based on the cost of print per page is very important.

There are two main design philosophies in inkjet-head design: fixed-head and disposable-head. Each has its own pros and cons. Most industrial inkjet printers come with fixed-head technology.

For home use, we mostly have disposable-head printers. Cost of the cartridge is high for disposable-head printers as the head that sprays ink on the paper is replaced every time we replace a cartridge. Printing improves as soon as we change the cartridge.

A few home printers also come with fixed-head technology, where we have an ink tank attached to the fixed head. Ink in the tank is refilled/replaced once it finishes, but the head remains there till the life of the printer. In such printers, cost per page is low but the ink-head replacement or repairing is expensive.

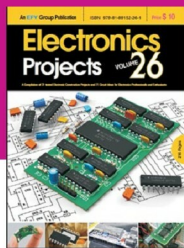
Other useful features. Some other aspects that can also help in deciding the right printer are attached display, ease of settings, unattended printing, memory and supported operating systems.

Just like most IT hardware, a printer, too can be bought online or from a local store. It does not make any difference where you buy it from, but it is important what you buy. Websites of most manufacturers of printers have an elaborate list of places from where you can buy the model you like in your local market. Online portals like Flipkart and Amazon provide you with features using which you can compare multi-brand printers at one place.

To sum up, you should buy a printer as per your requirement of printing. Running cost or cost per page of printing is of utmost importance. Avoid spending too much on features that are not needed, but always go with the latest technology available as the printer is likely to last for a long time. **EFY**

Electronics Projects Vol. 26 is the latest volume in the series, available in digital form.

It is a compilation of 21 construction projects and 71 circuit ideas published in Electronics For You magazine.



This collection of tested circuit ideas and construction projects in a handy volume would interest all classes of electronics enthusiasts—be they students, teachers, hobbyists or professionals!

Electronics Projects Vol. 26 is available on the following digital magazine stores:

- www.lulu.com
- www.magzter.com
- rockstand.in
- www.readwhere.com
- pothi.com